F Mich 11 Grammar notes

The perfect tense (AVOIR verbs)

- This tense is used to describe
  - **What you did** *(I ate)*
  - **What you have done** *(I have eaten)*

- Only the context tells you whether *j'ai mangé* means *I ate* or *I have eaten*.

- Always use the perfect tense to describe **one-off EVENTS in the past**

- Although English has a two-word past tense (*have eaten*) and a one-word past tense (*ate*), **the French perfect tense always has two parts**. The first part is called **the auxiliary verb**, and the second part is called **the past participle**.

- Most verbs use the present tense of AVOIR as the auxiliary verb. **To form regular past participles**, you need to change the ending of the infinitive as follows:
  - mangER – mang**É**
  - finIR - fin**I**
  - vendRE - vend**U**

> *nous avons mangé* *il a fini* *elles ont vendu*

- As usual, though a small group, **the most frequently needed past particples are irregular:**

avoir	**eu**	*voir*	**vu**
être	**été**	*recevoir*	**reçu**
faire	**fait**	*boire*	**bu**
dire	**dit**	*devoir*	**dû**
écrire	**écrit**	*savoir*	**su**
ouvrir	**ouvert**	*vivre*	**vécu**
conduire	**conduit**	*vouloir*	**voulu**
connaître	**connu**	*pouvoir*	**pu**
paraître	**paru**	*lire*	**lu**
croire	**cru**	*prendre*	**pris**
pleuvoir	**plu**	*mettre*	**mis**
tenir	**tenu**	*suivre*	**suivi**
venir	**venu**	*rire*	**ri**
courir	**couru**		

Regular –RE verbs

- There are very few of these. But as usual:
  - **Remove the infinitive ending** RE (vend~~re~~, répond~~re~~)
  - You are left with the "stem". **Add the personal ending to the stem**
    1. je VEND – **s**
    2. tu VEND – **s**
    3. il/elle VEND – nothing
    4. nous VEND – **ons**
    5. vous VEND – **ez**
    6. ils VEND – **ent**

- Some other common verbs which follow this pattern are:

pendre	*to hang*	**perdre**	*to lose*
rendre	*to give back*	**répondre**	*to answer*
tondre (la pelouse)	*to mow (the lawn)*	**vendre**	*to sell*
attendre	*to wait (for)*	**entendre**	*to hear*

Irregular –RE verbs

- **These very common –RE verbs are irregular.**

prendre *(to take)*

je	*prends*
tu	*prends*
il/elle/on	*prend*
nous	***pren**ons*
vous	***pren**ez*
ils/elles	***prenn**ent*

mettre *(to put/on)*

je	*mets*
tu	*mets*
il/elle/on	*met*
nous	*mettons*
vous	*mettez*
ils/elles	*mettent*

connaître *(to know/be familiar with)*

je	*connais*
tu	*connais*
il/elle/on	***connaît*** *(accent before a "t")*
nous	*connaissons*
vous	*connaissez*
ils/elles	*connaissent*

faire *(to do/make)*

je	*fais*
tu	*fais*
il/elle/on	*fait*
nous	*faisons*
vous	***faites*** *(no accent)*
ils	*font*